

Submitting Hanguk to the App Store

What to do now — every step, in order. Version 1.0 has been rejected four times; the code causes are fixed and merged. What remains is the upload itself and four things only a person with a Mac and a phone can do.

You need a Mac with Xcode. An iOS archive cannot be built or signed on Linux, in a container, or in the cloud. Steps 2–6 must happen on that machine.

The numbers you will need

Bundle ID	com.hanguk.studentapp.hangukApp
Current version	1.0.27+2044 — marketing 1.0.27, build 2044
Last build reviewed	1.0 (2042) — reviewed four times, never replaced
Device family	iPhone only (UIDeviceFamily = [1])
Minimum iOS	15.0
Demo Magic Code	In App Store Connect → App Review Information. The database row is "DEMO — Google Play Reviewer (do not delete)".

Already fixed — you do not need to check these

Continuous integration now builds the app on macOS on every change to the iOS project and fails the build if any of these regress:

- The CocoaPods setup resolves and the app compiles
- The microphone is compiled into the binary — without this the AI mock interview silently gets no microphone
- UIDeviceFamily is [1] (iPhone only)
- The microphone permission description ships in Info.plist
- The Dart code compiles, passes analysis, and passes 246 tests

The sign-in failure that caused the 14 August rejection is also fixed and already live on the server: the login now retries when the database is briefly unreachable, and reports a connection problem instead of telling the student their access code is wrong.

The steps

1 Raise the build number

Edit `hanguk_app/pubspec.yaml`. Only the number after the + has to change — App Store Connect rejects a build number it has already seen. The part before the + can stay as it is; you are resubmitting the same version, not creating a new one.

```
version: 1.0.27+2045
```

2 Build the archive

On the Mac, in a terminal:

```
cd hanguk_app
flutter clean && flutter pub get
flutter build ipa --release --dart-define=STORE_BUILD=true
```

The `--dart-define=STORE_BUILD=true` flag is **not optional**. Without it the build keeps a self-updater that Google Play has already blocked once.

3 Check the archive before uploading

Two minutes here saves two weeks of review.

```
/usr/libexec/PlistBuddy -c "Print :UIDeviceFamily" \
  build/ios/iphoneos/Runner.app/Info.plist
```

It must print **[1]**. If it prints **[1, 2]**, stop — an iPad-eligible app makes App Store Connect keep every iPad screenshot slot active and makes review run on an iPad. That is what caused two of the four rejections.

4 Test on a real iPhone

Install the build on a device and check two things by hand. No automated system can do either.

- a. Sign in with the demo Magic Code — on *this* build, not a previous one.
- b. Start an AI mock interview and confirm the microphone permission dialog appears.

The microphone fix is new code. If the dialog does not appear, stop and report it before uploading.

5 Upload

Xcode → Window → Organizer → select the archive → *Distribute App* → App Store Connect → Upload. The Transporter app works equally well.

Processing takes 5–30 minutes. You will get an email when the build appears. **It is not attached to anything yet.**

6 Attach the build to the version

This is the step that was missed four times.

App Store Connect → your app → the version under *iOS App* → scroll to **Build** → click + → select the build you just uploaded → **Save**.

Then reload the page and read the Build section again. It must show the number you just uploaded. If it still shows an older one, review will run on the older one and every fix is invisible to Apple.

Uploading is not attaching.

7 Empty the iPad screenshot slots

Screenshots → the device-size dropdown → **View All Sizes in Media Manager**. Walk every size, delete every iPad screenshot, and repeat for **each language** — en-US, ko, uz.

The default view hides sizes. A leftover image on a size you never expanded fails review on its own; that is exactly what happened on 12 August. An iPhone-only app needs no iPad screenshots at all, and an empty slot cannot fail.

8 Copy the description and keywords

Take them from `STORE_METADATA.md` in the repository. Do not write new text in the App Store Connect box.

That file is deliberately no wider than what the app actually does. Claiming more than the app shows is what caused the 7 August rejection. Keywords are limited to 100 characters including commas.

9 Fill in App Review Information

Hanguk signs in with a single field, which reviewers do not expect, so the notes have to say so.

User name: the demo Magic Code (the field is required)

Password: the same Magic Code

Notes: explain that there is one field, not a username and password — suggested wording is in `store/APP_REVIEW_2026-08-05.md`

Check the demo account still has real content: an application, an uploaded document, a study plan. An account that signs in to empty tabs is rejected for a different reason.

10 Submit, then verify four things

Add for Review → *Submit to App Review*. Then check, in this order — each of these has failed at least once:

1. The Build section shows the new build number
2. Every iPad screenshot size is empty, in every language
3. The Support URL opens in a browser
4. Export compliance did not ask again — the answer now ships in the app

If it is rejected again

Check the server logs before assuming the app is at fault. On 14 August the reviewer was told their access code was invalid. The code was correct — the database had been unreachable for ninety minutes, and the app reported an outage as a bad code. That was visible in the logs and nowhere in the app.

Then write the rejection down as `store/APP_REVIEW_<date>.md`: the guideline cited, what Apple actually said, and what was changed. The four existing files are the reason the last rejection took an hour to diagnose instead of a week.